investigating the September 11 terrorist attacks, Attorney General John Ashcroft said, “The single greatest structural cause for the September 11th problem was the wall that segregated or separated criminal investigators and intelligence agents.”

The *third working assumption* is that an intelligence system cannot function effectively only on the basis of procedures and “authority charts.” An intelligence system that is not based on discretion, along with procedures, is doomed to fail. A good intelligence organization knows how to distinguish between having tunnel vision and having gumption. Someone with tunnel vision works only according to procedures and is afraid to exercise discretion. Someone with gumption is not afraid to exercise discretion even if it involves potential risks. The dynamics of intelligence systems are so rapid that no mechanism or updating of procedures can catch up with them. In my opinion, we must encourage more gumption in our system, for people with this quality have an added value without which the danger that the organization will stagnate increases.

In the course of the Agranat Commission’s investigations, it emerged that Lieutenant Benjamin Siman-Tov, an officer in a relatively junior position in the Southern Command’s intelligence unit, wrote an assessment that deviated completely from the intelligence assessment of the Southern Command and of the Intelligence Directorate at IDF headquarters. The prevailing assessment interpreted the movements of the Egyptian army in the days preceding the war as part of an exercise, and any information that indicated that Egypt was preparing for war was deciphered as a deception intended to confuse Israel and cause it to put its army in a state of alert in vain. The young lieutenant, on the other hand, understood the information he had received and the Egyptian army movements to be signs indicating an intention of war. However, his assessment remained stuck in the Southern Command’s intelligence unit because of the rigid military hierarchy: his commander, the Southern Command’s intelligence officer, refused to pass it on to his superiors. The commission of inquiry established a precedent when it recommended that the Intelligence Corps allow for the breaking of the hierarchy in similar cases in the future so that atypical intelligence assessments could bypass the regular chain of command and go directly to headquarters. The IDF adopted this principle and has adhered to it to this day.